

The God of Sticks and Stones

Scripture, Creation, and the Quiet Language of God

Closing Reflection A — The Laborer's Return

The work is still waiting for you.

Not the extraordinary kind — just the ordinary. The meetings and the dishes. The conversation that doesn't quite resolve. The commute. The inbox. The neighbor whose name you keep meaning to learn.

You have been walking through something slow and old. And now the ordinary day is in front of you again, with its small weight, asking for your presence.

This is not a descent.

Those who worked close to the ground understood that faithfulness rarely meant stepping away from ordinary life. It meant bringing a different quality of attention into it. Showing up. Tending what was given to them to tend.

You don't have to be extraordinary at this.

You only need to remain present.

And the one who worked with his hands, who ate with people who weren't certain they belonged at the table, has always been willing to meet you in the ordinary hours — in the commute, in the kitchen, in the work that will still be there tomorrow morning.

He did not require spectacle from the people he met along the road.

He is not requiring it now.

So go back to the work.

Quietly, and with purpose — the way a laborer returns after a long rest. The task was always ordinary. And you were always enough to carry it.